Ivory Coast (:)

SEPTEMBER 2026 Gambling Market & Regulatory Brief · Published 21 Oct 2026 (Blask/iGaming Afrika Sept-26 demand read; ARJH market data FY2024; LONACI FY2025 results of 2 Feb 2026) · Currency XOF (CFA franc) – tables in billions (bn) unless stated; ~USD shown at an ASSUMED 560 XOF/USD (see confidence note)

CONFIDENTIAL · INTERNAL
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THE ONE-LINE VERDICT

Côte d'Ivoire is a fast-growing (~XOF 706bn / ~$1.26bn licensed-sector turnover in 2024, +20.5% YoY) but structurally closed market: every online vertical – sports betting, online casino, virtuals – sits inside LONACI's exclusive State concession, and the 17 private brands on the ARJH register (up from 3 in Dec 2023) trade only as LONACI agrément-holders. September 2026 crystallised the tension in that model: national search demand rose 21.7% MoM and 12.6% YoY, Betclic took 55.2% of it, and the concessionaire's own online brand slipped to 6%. For an entrant the question is not 'can we get a licence' but 'can we secure a LONACI agrément on economics that survive a 5% online tax, 30% corporate tax, a 7.5% player-winnings withholding and a regulator that is visibly hardening enforcement (USSJH decree, April 2026).'

LICENSED-SECTOR TURNOVER FY2024 (ARJH)	LONACI TURNOVER FY2025	PRIVATE ONLINE BRANDS UNDER LONACI AGRÉMENT	BETCLIC SHARE OF SEPT-26 SEARCH DEMAND (BLASK BAP)	ONLINE GAMBLING TAX (NON-CONCESSIONAIRE)	LONACI CONCESSION FEE (REDEVANCE) TO STATE FY2025
XOF 705.9bn (~$1.26bn)	**XOF 657.6bn (~$1.17bn)**	**17**	**55.2%**	**5% of net gaming receipts**	**XOF 21bn (~$38m)**
+20.5% YoY (turnover basis, not GGR)	+13.5% YoY; 2026 target XOF 744.3bn (~$1.33bn)	from 3 in Dec 2023 (ARJH register, Oct 2026)	+3.1pp MoM; Lonaci Online 6% (-2pp)	LONACI's own tax 5%→7% of net product from Jan 2025	+40% vs XOF 15bn (~$27m) FY2024

1 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

- **A ~$1.3bn-turnover market growing >20% a year.** The ARJH puts the licensed sector's global chiffre d'affaires at XOF 705.9bn (~$1.26bn) in 2024 vs XOF 585.9bn (~$1.05bn) in 2023 (+20.5%) and XOF 455.0bn (~$0.81bn) in 2022 (+28.8% in 2023). These are turnover/stakes-type figures; the regulator does not publish sector GGR, online/retail splits or product GGR – the single biggest data gap for an entrant.
- **LONACI is ~82% of the licensed market.** The State lottery's turnover was XOF 579.3bn (~$1.03bn) in 2024, implying private agrément-holders plus casinos and slot halls generated ~XOF 126.6bn (~$226m) of 2024 turnover (derived). LONACI grew a further 13.5% to XOF 657.6bn (~$1.17bn) in 2025 and targets XOF 744.3bn (~$1.33bn) in 2026 (+13%).
- **Implied LONACI GGR ~XOF 244bn (~$435m).** Winnings paid were XOF 413.9bn (~$739m) in 2025 (+17%), a 62.9% payout (61.1% in 2024); stakes less winnings gives an estimated gross gaming revenue of ~XOF 243.7bn in 2025, up only ~8% as payout rose – LONACI is buying growth with price (derived estimate; LONACI does not report GGR).
- **Growth is not converting to profit for the concessionaire.** Per LONACI's 2025 accounts (Afriveille), value added fell to XOF 33.5bn (~$60m) from XOF 43.0bn (~$77m), EBITDA (EBE) fell 37% to XOF 21.0bn (~$38m) and net profit fell >43% (management guided XOF 12.6bn / ~$22m). A squeezed concessionaire is a concessionaire likely to extract more from its partners.
- **One regulator, two regimes.** Loi 2020-480 (27 May 2020) created the Autorité de Régulation des Jeux de Hasard (ARJH, organised by Décret 2021-301) and split gambling into (i) a concession regime – an exclusive State convention with LONACI signed 5 July 2021 and detailed by Décret 2023-945 (6 Dec 2023, in force 1 Jan 2024) – and (ii) an authorisation regime run by the ARJH under Décret 2023-946 for promotional/charitable lotteries, land-based casinos and slot halls.
- **Everything online is concessioned.** The ARJH's own game-offer list places national lotteries, instant/number/scratch games, horse and sports betting, virtuals, online games, online casino and online slots under the concession. Its FAQ is explicit that online sports betting has been conceded to LONACI and is not open to competition – there is no stand-alone private online licence in Côte d'Ivoire.
- **Private brands exist only as LONACI agrément-holders.** The 2021 concession convention lets LONACI grant agréments to third-party operators; it listed 3 (1xBet, Betclic, PremierBet) on 8 Dec 2023. The ARJH register now carries 17 online/sports-betting operators: 1xBet, Betclic, Choplife, Betmomo, Melbet, Akwabet, Betwinner, Paripesa, Betchoc, Afropari, Kifbet, Bet 360, Winabet, Betpawa, Betway, Wariplay and BetWys. Agrément fees, revenue shares and durations are not published (n/a).
- **Betclic dominates attention; LONACI's own online brand is marginal.** Blask's September 2026 read: national demand +21.7% MoM and +12.6% YoY; Betclic 55.2% of brand demand (52.1% in August), 1xBet 11.8%, Lonaci Online 6% (8% in August); the top five hold ~90% of measured demand across 52 brands. These are search-demand shares, not GGR shares – treat as directional only.
- **Gaming tax stack – concessionaire:** Art. 1149 CGI levies a taxe sur les jeux de hasard of 7% on the net product of sales, commissions and brokerage (a GGR-type base), raised from 5% by Loi 2024-1109 (Annexe fiscale 2025; expected yield +XOF 2bn / ~$4m), plus the concession redevance – XOF 21bn (~$38m) in 2025, +40% – equal to ~3.2% of LONACI turnover or ~8.6% of its implied GGR.
- **Gaming tax stack – private online operators:** Art. 1150 CGI (Annexe fiscale 2024, art. 4) imposes a 5% tax on net gaming receipts on all online operators other than the concessionaire, regardless of where they are established; locally-established partners remit via LONACI by the 15th of the following month, offshore operators file online under CGI arts. 437–439 or face suspension of platform access. From 2025, 15% of this tax is earmarked for the Office National des Sports.
- **Corporate and player taxes bite harder than headline gaming tax.** Annexe fiscale 2025 lifted the corporate income tax (BIC) rate for gambling companies from 25% to 30% (UEMOA directive alignment). Art. 94 CGI imposes a 7.5% withholding on winnings ≥ XOF 1,000,000 (~$1,786), excluding slot winnings, since the 2018 budget, and a 7.5% withholding on commissions paid to non-salaried resellers/agents.
- **2026 adds a 'virtual permanent establishment' tax.** The 2026 budget (Loi 2025-987, in force 5 Jan 2026) taxes foreign online platforms with ≥ XOF 50m (~$89k) of remote Ivorian sales at 30% of a deemed 10%

margin (3% of turnover), creditable against Art. 92 withholding, with tougher sanctions for non-compliant platforms – a further lever against offshore grey operators.

- **Land-based is small and tightly ring-fenced.** The ARJH authorises 6 casinos (Casino Barrière Eléphant d'Or, Ice Passion, ShinyGold, Porte d'Orient, Elephant Slot, Casino Gate) and 2 slot-hall operators (Lydia Ludic; VIP Slot by LONACI). Casinos and slot halls may operate only within 4-star hotels; entry age is 21 (18 for all other games). Authorisation fees ('contreparties financières' under Décret 2023-946) are not published (n/a).
- **Enforcement is hardening.** The ARJH incinerated 110 seized slot machines plus 84 boxes and 13 bags of components at Bingerville on 28 Aug 2025. On 29 Apr 2026 the Council of Ministers adopted Décret 2026-236 creating the Unité de Surveillance du Secteur des Jeux de Hasard (USSJH) – sworn agents, security forces and ARJH staff with nationwide investigation, finding and repression powers – explicitly targeting unauthorised slot and loto operators.
- **Payments run on mobile money.** Two registered operators are literally named after the rail (BetMobile Money SA/Betmomo; MPayment SAS/Winabet). Quantitative mobile-money share of deposits, wallet limits and fee data are not published by the regulator (n/a) – model on mobile-money dominance, with cards and bank transfer marginal.
- **Responsible gambling is rule-light but obligation-heavy.** The law fixes 18+/21+ ages and the ARJH runs addiction-prevention, minor-protection, AML and match-fixing programmes; operators must keep analytical accounts, file an annual activity report with flows by product and three-year comparisons, and lodge certified accounts (Loi 2020-480 arts. 12–15). Specific advertising/bonus restrictions were not located in the texts read [unverified]; sponsorship (Betclic–ASEC Mimosas, 1xBet–FIF/CAN 2023, LONACI–CAN 2025) is clearly permitted in practice.
- **Fiscal direction of travel is up, not down.** Three consecutive budgets (2024, 2025, 2026) have each added or raised a gambling-relevant tax; the 2025 exposé des motifs justifies this by youth exposure to betting and the need to fund sport and civic-service programmes. Expect the 2027 Annexe fiscale (Dec 2026) to revisit rates or the winnings-withholding threshold.
- **Read-through for B2Tech.** Entry is a commercial negotiation with LONACI (agrément) followed by ARJH registration, not an open licence process; the economics are set by an unpublished partner fee plus a ~5% net-receipts tax, 30% BIC and payout pressure from a 63%-payout incumbent. The prize is a ~$1.3bn-turnover market still compounding >13%, concentrated in sports betting, with one dominant private brand (Betclic) and a long tail of 15 CIS/Africa-focused bookmakers; the risks are concession-partner dependency, rising taxes and a regulator now equipped to block and prosecute.

2 MARKET SUMMARY

CÔTE D'IVOIRE – XOF BN (~USD AT ASSUMED 560 XOF/USD)	VALUE	PERIOD	YOY / CHANGE	BASIS & SOURCE
MARKET SIZE (TURNOVER BASIS – REGULATOR DOES NOT PUBLISH GGR)				
Licensed-sector global turnover	**XOF 705.9bn (~$1.26bn)**	**FY2024**	**+20.5%**	**Chiffre d'affaires global, all licensed operators – ARJH 'Marché des jeux'**
Licensed-sector global turnover	XOF 585.9bn (~$1.05bn)	FY2023	+28.8%	ARJH data cited by Abidjan.net (XOF 585,871,594,004)
Licensed-sector global turnover	XOF 455.0bn (~$0.81bn)	FY2022	n/a	ARJH data cited by Abidjan.net (XOF 455,009,166,271)
LONACI turnover (concessionaire)	XOF 657.6bn (~$1.17bn)	FY2025	+13.5% (579.3bn in 2024)	Sales/stakes-type turnover – LONACI DG via AIP, 2 Feb 2026
LONACI winnings paid to players	XOF 413.9bn (~$739m)	FY2025	+17%; payout 62.9% (61.1% in 2024)	LONACI via AIP
LONACI implied GGR (turnover – winnings)	~XOF 243.7bn (~$435m)	FY2025	~+8% (est. 225.5bn in 2024)	Analyst derivation – not reported by LONACI [estimate]
LONACI share of licensed-sector turnover	~82%	FY2024	n/a	Derived: 579.3 / 705.9
Non-LONACI turnover (private online agrément-holders + casinos + slot halls)	~XOF 126.6bn (~$226m)	FY2024	n/a	Derived residual [estimate]
Sector GGR / NGR; GGR by product	n/a	—	—	Not published by ARJH or LONACI
Online penetration	n/a	—	LONACI retail network +9% vs group +14% (2025) ⇒ digital outgrowing retail	Not published; directional only
DEMAND INDICATORS (SEARCH-BASED, BLASK – SECONDARY)				
Blask Index – national iGaming demand	+21.7% MoM	Sept 2026	+12.6% YoY; peak Jan–Feb 2026	Blask via iGaming Afrika, 21 Oct 2026
Brand share of demand (BAP): Betclic / 1xBet / Lonaci Online	55.2% / 11.8% / 6.0%	Sept 2026	Betclic +3.1pp; 1xBet flat; Lonaci -2pp MoM	Top-5 ≈ 90% of demand; 52 brands measured
LICENSING				
Concessionaire (exclusive, all online + retail lottery/betting)	1 – LONACI	Oct 2026	Convention 5 Jul 2021; Décret 2023-945	ARJH register
Private online / sports-betting brands under LONACI agrément	17	Oct 2026	3 in Dec 2023	ARJH register; LONACI communiqué 8 Dec 2023
Land-based casinos authorised (ARJH)	6	Oct 2026	n/a	ARJH register; 4-star-hotel rule; 21+
Slot-hall operators authorised (ARJH)	2	Oct 2026	n/a	Lydia Ludic; VIP Slot by LONACI (SAS Terroubi)
Licence / agrément fees	n/a	—	—	Décret 2023-946 sets 'contreparties financières'; amounts not published
TAX REGIME				
Taxe sur les jeux de hasard – Art. 1149 CGI (concessionaire)	7% of net product of sales, commissions & brokerage (GGR-type base)	From Jan 2025	Raised from 5% (Loi 2024-1109); yield est. +XOF 2bn (~$4m)	DGBF Annexe fiscale 2025; CGI
Taxe sur les jeux de hasard en ligne – Art. 1150 CGI (non-concessionaire online operators)	5% of net gaming receipts	Since 2024	15% of proceeds earmarked to Office National des Sports from 2025	Annexe fiscale 2024 art. 4; Annexe fiscale 2025 art. 22
Corporate income tax (BIC) – gambling companies	30%	From 2025	Raised from 25%	Annexe fiscale 2025
Player winnings withholding – Art. 94 CGI	7.5% on wins ≥ XOF 1,000,000 (~$1,786); slots exempt	Since 2018	n/a	Loi 2017-870 (Annexe fiscale 2018); Trésor public
Withholding on commissions to non-salaried resellers/agents – Art. 94 CGI	7.5% of gross amounts	Current	n/a	CGI
LONACI concession redevance to State	XOF 21bn (~$38m)	FY2025	+40% (XOF 15bn / ~$27m in 2024); ≈3.2% of turnover	LONACI via AIP
'Virtual permanent establishment' tax on foreign online platforms	30% × deemed 10% margin = 3% of turnover, above XOF 50m (~$89k) sales	From 5 Jan 2026	New	Loi 2025-987 / Annexe fiscale 2026
Total State take from gambling (all taxes)	n/a	—	—	Not published
PLAYER RULES				
Minimum age	18 (21 for casinos & slot halls)	Current	—	Loi 2020-480 art. 59

3 DEEP-DIVE — SPORTS BETTING (ONLINE & RETAIL) – THE LONACI CONCESSION AND ITS 17 PARTNER BRANDS

The only route online is a LONACI agrément; Betclic has turned that route into a 55% share of demand while the concessionaire's own online brand fades to 6%.

LEGAL ROUTE ONLINE

The only route online is a LONACI agrément; the register has expanded from 3 to 17 online/sports-betting operators in under three years.

- Décret 2023-945 grants LONACI exclusive rights over the physical network and a segment of the virtual network including lotteries, horse, sports and virtual betting.
- Council of Ministers communiqué of 6 December 2023 prohibits operating concessioned games to any operator other than LONACI; ARJH FAQ says online sports betting is not subject to competition.
- The 5 July 2021 State–LONACI concession convention authorises LONACI to grant agréments to third-party operators.
- LONACI listed three agréments (1xBet, Betclic, PremierBet) on 8 December 2023; the ARJH register read in October 2026 carries 17, a near-sixfold expansion.
- AfriBallon barometer (Oct 2026) records the same 3-to-17 progression.

COMPETITIVE COHORT

The 17-brand cohort is dominated by CIS-origin and pan-African brands, with Betclic the only Western European tier-one operator and the clear leader.

- Register includes Betclic Côte d'Ivoire SAS, Ludus SAS (1xBet), Coastwin (Melbet), Digital Future LLC (Betwinner), Latania (Paripesa), Novaco (Afropari), Daci Speed (Betpawa), Yellowbet (Betway).
- Also Betmobile Money SA (Betmomo), Choplife, Akwabet, Betchoc, Kifbet, Bet 360, Winabet, Wariplay and BetWys.
- PremierBet, one of the original three, no longer appears.
- CIS-origin brands (1xBet, Melbet, Betwinner, Paripesa) and pan-African challengers (Betpawa, Betway, Choplife) dominate.

BRAND MARKET SHARE

Blask's September 2026 read shows Betclic at 55.2% of search demand, 1xBet 11.8% and Lonaci Online down to 6%.

- National search demand rose 21.7% month-on-month and 12.6% year-on-year, the strongest month since the January–February 2026 peak, coinciding with the Côte d'Ivoire–Ghana AFCON qualifier on 24 September.
- Betclic's Brand Accumulated Power rose from 52.1% to 55.2%; Lonaci Online slipped from 8% to 6%, a leader-to-concessionaire gap of more than nine times.
- Fifty-two brands registered demand but the top five captured roughly nine-tenths.
- These are search-demand shares, not stakes or GGR, and over-weight heavy advertisers; ordering is consistent with Betclic's ASEC Mimosas sponsorship and 1xBet's FIF/CAN 2023 partnership.

LONACI SPORTS PRODUCT

LONACI's sports product is a relaunch story; retail turnover grew 9% in 2025 against 14% for the group, so retail remains its structural advantage.

- 2025 review cites relaunch of Sportcash, deployment of MAJX by LONACI, sponsorship of CAN Maroc 2025 and, for 2026, 'la relance des paris sportifs et hippiques' toward the XOF 744.3bn (~$1.33bn) turnover target.
- Points of sale up 20% and more than 300 outlets re-branded.
- Sector sports-betting GGR is not published (n/a); only hard numbers are LONACI's group payout (62.9%) and the derived ~XOF 244bn (~$435m) group GGR estimate spanning lottery, scratch, horse and sports.

ENTRANT IMPLICATIONS

The agrément is the asset, the tax stack is low on gaming tax but heavy elsewhere, and extreme concentration demands a differentiated acquisition angle.

- Agrément terms (fee, revenue share, duration, exclusivity, product scope) are bilateral with LONACI and undisclosed; due diligence must go through LONACI and existing partners.
- The 5% Art. 1150 tax on net receipts is low by African standards (Kenya 15% GGR excise plus 20% withholding on wins; Ghana 20% GGR).
- It stacks with 30% BIC, the partner fee, and a 7.5% withholding on wins ≥ XOF 1m that depresses high-ticket sports multiples.
- A single brand holds over half of demand and the long tail of 15 brands shares perhaps a third.
- A new entrant needs mobile-money UX, local payments or crash/virtuals rather than another odds-led bookmaker proposition.

SPORTS BETTING – XOF BN (~USD AT 560)	VALUE	PERIOD	CHANGE	BASIS & SOURCE
LEGAL BASIS				
Online & retail sports betting status	Concessioned to LONACI (exclusive)	Since 1 Jan 2024 (decree)	Private brands via LONACI agrément only	Décret 2023-945; ARJH FAQ
Private sports-betting brands on ARJH register	17	Oct 2026	3 in Dec 2023 (1xBet, Betclic, PremierBet)	ARJH register; LONACI communiqué
DEMAND & SHARE (BLASK, SEARCH-BASED)				
National Blask Index	+21.7% MoM	Sept 2026	+12.6% YoY	iGaming Afrika / Blask
Betclic BAP	55.2%	Sept 2026	+3.1pp MoM	Blask
1xBet BAP	11.8%	Sept 2026	flat MoM	Blask
Lonaci Online BAP	6.0%	Sept 2026	-2.0pp MoM	Blask
Top-5 share / brands measured	~90% / 52	Sept 2026	n/a	Blask
CONCESSIONAIRE DATA (ALL PRODUCTS – SPORTS NOT SEPARATELY DISCLOSED)				
LONACI turnover	XOF 657.6bn (~$1.17bn)	FY2025	+13.5%	AIP
LONACI payout ratio	62.9%	FY2025	+1.8pp	Derived from AIP figures
LONACI retail-network turnover growth	+9%	FY2025	POS +20%; >300 outlets re-branded	AIP
Sector sports-betting GGR / handle	n/a	—	—	Not published
Tax on private online sports betting	5% of net gaming receipts + 30% BIC + 7.5% WHT on wins ≥ XOF 1m	2025–26	—	CGI arts. 1150, 94; Annexe fiscale 2025

4 DEEP-DIVE — ONLINE CASINO, VIRTUALS & CRASH – CONCESSIONED, UNDER-DOCUMENTED

Online casino and online slots are on the concession list, so private casino content reaches Ivorians only inside a LONACI agrément – a legal grey zone with no published market data.

CONCESSION SCOPE

Online casino and online slots sit on the concession list, so private casino content reaches Ivorians only inside a LONACI agrément.

- ARJH game-offer page lists 'les jeux de casino en ligne', 'les machines à sous en ligne', 'les jeux virtuels' and 'les jeux en ligne' under the concession regime.
- Loi 2020-480 defines the concession as covering casino games and slot machines 'uniquement par voie de canaux et réseaux de communication électroniques' together with 'les jeux en ligne'.
- Land-based casino and slot activity is a private, authorised business; any remote casino product belongs to the State concessionaire.
- No separate online casino licence class, no published RTP or certification standard beyond systematic homologation of gaming software, and no segment revenue disclosure.

AGRÉMENT-HOLDER CASINO SCOPE

Several agrément-holders are casino- or crash-led brands, but whether each agrément extends beyond sports betting is undisclosed and unverified.

- Choplife and Betchoc are marketed around crash and instant games; 1xBet, Melbet, Betwinner and Paripesa carry full casino lobbies in other markets.
- Whether each agrément extends to casino and virtuals could not be verified in this research pass [unverified].
- ARJH phrasing 'opérateurs de jeux en ligne / paris sportifs' suggests a broader category, but commercial scope is contractual with LONACI.

LONACI DIGITAL PUSH

LONACI's digital book grew materially faster than retail, which grew 9% against 14% for the group, but online casino size is unknowable from public data.

- Management credits 2025 growth to 'paris sportifs, jeux numériques' and sets 'accélération de la digitalisation' as the first 2026 lever.
- MAJX by LONACI was deployed in 2025.
- No online/retail split exists in LONACI or ARJH reporting.

FISCAL TREATMENT

Private online casino content faces the same 5% Art. 1150 tax and 30% BIC, with an untested slot-winnings withholding exemption and a new virtual-PE tax.

- The 7.5% winnings withholding exempts slot-machine winnings under Art. 94 CGI, drafted for physical slots; application to online slots is untested [unverified].
- The 2026 'virtual permanent establishment' tax (3% of turnover above XOF 50m / ~$89k) targets offshore platforms selling to Ivorian consumers.
- It gives the DGI a basis to pursue unlicensed casino sites even before the ARJH blocks them.

B2TECH IMPLICATION

Casino is an add-on to a LONACI sports agrément rather than a stand-alone opportunity, with regulatory risk that LONACI narrows third-party scope.

- Product approval (homologation) and scope must be negotiated explicitly.
- Any plan should model the risk that the concessionaire narrows third-party casino scope to protect its own digital products as its margins compress.

ONLINE CASINO / VIRTUALS – STATUS AND DATA AVAILABILITY	VALUE	PERIOD	CHANGE	BASIS & SOURCE
Online casino & online slots – legal status	Concessioned (LONACI-exclusive); private offer only via LONACI agrément	Since 1 Jan 2024	—	ARJH 'Offres de jeux'; Loi 2020-480
Virtual games / virtual sports	Concessioned	Since 1 Jan 2024	—	ARJH; Décret 2023-945
Stand-alone private online casino licence	None exists	Current	—	ARJH regimes
Software homologation	Mandatory, systematic	Current	—	ARJH operators page
Online casino GGR / actives / RTP standards	n/a	—	—	Not published
Casino-/crash-led brands on register	Choplife, Betchoc (+ CIS multi-product brands)	Oct 2026	—	ARJH register; brand positioning [scope unverified]
Winnings withholding on slot wins	Exempt from 7.5% WHT (physical-slot drafting; online application untested)	Current	—	CGI art. 94

5 DEEP-DIVE — LOTTERY, RETAIL & LAND-BASED (CASINOS AND SLOT HALLS)

LONACI's retail lottery estate is the market's backbone (~XOF 658bn turnover, 63% payout); land-based casino and slot activity is private but confined to six 4-star-hotel casinos and two slot-hall operators, with illegal slots the enforcement priority.

LONACI RETAIL ESTATE

LONACI turnover rose from XOF 369.4bn (~$660m) in 2021 to XOF 657.6bn (~$1.17bn) in 2025, +78% in four years.

- LONACI is a majority State-owned company celebrating 55 years in 2026.
- Beat its XOF 545bn (~$973m) target for 2024 by a wide margin (actual XOF 579.3bn / ~$1.03bn).
- 2025 total: XOF 587.4bn (~$1.05bn) sales of works and services and XOF 69.9bn (~$125m) ancillary income (Afriveille).
- Winnings paid XOF 413.9bn (~$739m), +17%; commissions to retail concessionaires rose 10%.
- Outlet count expanded 20%, with a new Yamoussoukro agency and several modernised gaming rooms.

LONACI PROFITABILITY

EBITDA margin fell to 3.2% from 5.7% and net profit fell more than 43% while the State redevance rose 40% to XOF 21bn (~$38m).

- Value added fell from XOF 43.0bn (~$77m) to XOF 33.5bn (~$60m); EBITDA from XOF 33.3bn (~$59m) to XOF 21.0bn (~$38m).
- Net profit guided at XOF 12.6bn (~$22m).
- Drivers cited: higher payout, network commissions, sponsorship (CAN Maroc 2025) and digital investment.
- Authorised to raise share capital from XOF 400m (~$0.7m) to XOF 5bn (~$9m); 2026–2030 strategic plan with loyalty programmes and new scratch games.
- A concessionaire whose margin has halved while its State levy rose 40% has every incentive to lift partner fees, cap partner numbers or push its own online brand.

LAND-BASED CASINOS

Land-based casino and slot activity is the only segment with direct ARJH authorisation, confined to six 4-star-hotel casinos and two slot-hall operators.

- Décret 2023-946 transferred authorisation competence to the ARJH and defines issuance, renewal, withdrawal and the financial consideration due to the State (amounts not published; n/a).
- Casinos and slot halls restricted to 4-star hotels and patrons aged 21+; casino operators face Loi 2020-480 arts. 16–17 on top of arts. 12–15.
- Six casinos: Casino Barrière Eléphant d'Or (Abidjan, SEEOA), Ice Passion, ShinyGold, Porte d'Orient, Elephant Slot (African Leisure & Entertainment) and Casino Gate (Cloud Gate).
- Two slot-hall operators: Lydia Ludic and SAS Terroubi's VIP Slot by LONACI, signalling the concessionaire's own entry into the slot-hall niche.

ENFORCEMENT PRIORITY

Illegal physical slots and informal loto are the enforcement priority; positive for licensed share but no legal path for route operators outside hotels.

- ARJH incinerated 110 seized machines and components at Akouedo-Attié, Bingerville, on 28 August 2025.
- Regulator framed it with market growth from XOF 455.0bn to 585.9bn (+28.76%) to argue growth attracts illegality.
- April 2026 USSJH decree cites the emergence of 'de nombreux opérateurs non autorisés, notamment des exploitants de machines à sous et de jeux de loto'.

CASINO DATA GAPS

Casino and slot-hall GGR, visitation and tax take are not disclosed, and the casino gaming-tax rate should be treated as unverified.

- Art. 1149's 7% applies to the net product of gaming sales, commissions and brokerage.
- Annexe fiscale 2025 refers to a 'prélèvement additionnel sur les jeux de hasard, de casino et de machines à sous', but the historical LONACI/casino 'prélèvement additionnel' title was repealed in 2016.
- Treat the casino gaming-tax rate as [unverified] pending the decree text.

LOTTERY, RETAIL & LAND-BASED – XOF BN (~USD AT 560)	VALUE	PERIOD	CHANGE	BASIS & SOURCE
LONACI (CONCESSIONAIRE)				
Turnover	XOF 657.6bn (~$1.17bn)	FY2025	+13.5%	AIP / LONACI DG
of which sales of works & services / ancillary	XOF 587.4bn (~$1.05bn) / XOF 69.9bn (~$125m)	FY2025	n/a	Afriveille (accounts)
Turnover FY2024 / FY2021	XOF 579.3bn (~$1.03bn) / XOF 369.4bn (~$660m)	FY2024 / FY2021	+78% over 2021–25	AIP; AfriBallon
Winnings paid	XOF 413.9bn (~$739m)	FY2025	+17%	AIP
Value added	XOF 33.5bn (~$60m)	FY2025	vs XOF 43.0bn (~$77m)	Afriveille
EBITDA (EBE) / margin on turnover	XOF 21.0bn (~$38m) / 3.2%	FY2025	-37%; 5.7% margin in 2024	Afriveille; derived margin
Net profit	XOF 12.6bn (~$22m) guided	FY2025	> -43%	AIP; Afriveille
Redevance paid to State	XOF 21bn (~$38m)	FY2025	+40%	AIP
Retail network turnover / POS count	+9% / +20%	FY2025	—	AIP
2026 turnover target	XOF 744.3bn (~$1.33bn)	FY2026	+13.2%	AIP
Share capital (authorised increase)	XOF 400m → XOF 5bn (~$0.7m → ~$9m)	2026	—	AIP
LAND-BASED PRIVATE (ARJH AUTHORISATION)				
Casinos authorised	6	Oct 2026	—	ARJH register
Slot-hall operators authorised	2	Oct 2026	—	ARJH register
Location / age rule	4-star hotels only; 21+	Current	—	Loi 2020-480 art. 59; MinFin
Authorisation fees; casino GGR; casino tax rate	n/a / n/a / [unverified]	—	—	Décret 2023-946 (amounts not published)
Illegal machines destroyed (Bingerville)	110 slots + 84 boxes + 13 bags of components	28 Aug 2025	—	KOACI / Abidjan.net

6 DEEP-DIVE — LICENSING & TAX – CONCESSION VS AUTHORISATION, AND A TAX STACK THAT RISES EVERY BUDGET

No open licence exists for online; the real 'licence' is a LONACI agrément. Gaming tax is modest (5%/7% of net receipts) but corporate tax is 30%, winnings are withheld at 7.5%, and three successive budgets have tightened the screw.

REGULATORY ARCHITECTURE

Loi 2020-480 creates the ARJH and two regimes: an exclusive LONACI concession for all online games and an ARJH authorisation regime for land-based and promotional games.

- Law defines gambling broadly (chance as even an accessory element) and gives the ARJH full powers over all operators including the exclusive-rights holder.
- Concession via convention signed 5 July 2021 and Décret 2023-945 of 6 December 2023 covers lotteries, instant and number games, scratch cards, horse and sports betting, virtuals, and all online games including casino and slots.
- Concessioned games are not subject to competition; art. 13 exempts the concessionaire from competition rules binding all other operators.
- Décret 2023-946 lets the ARJH authorise promotional lotteries, charitable lotteries, land-based casinos and slot halls; State consideration amounts not published (n/a).
- Applications are by letter to the ARJH specifying the game; gaming software must be homologated.

AGRÉMENT TERMS

Private online operators hold a LONACI agrément whose price and terms are not public; a local entity appears customary but perhaps not mandatory.

- Before 2024, local partners paid only a redevance to the Treasury through LONACI and no gaming tax, while offshore platforms paid nothing – a 'distorsion de concurrence' the Art. 1150 tax corrected.
- No local-ownership, local-server or local-director requirements were identified in the texts read.
- Register mixes local SAS/SARL vehicles (Betclic Côte d'Ivoire SAS, Ludus SAS) and at least one foreign LLC (Digital Future LLC/Betwinner) [unverified].

OPERATOR OBLIGATIONS

Common obligations under arts. 12–15 are substantive, covering analytical accounting, annual ARJH reporting, certified statements, tax payment and competition compliance.

- Analytical (cost) accounting on top of SYSCOHADA general accounts.
- Annual activity report detailing nature and volume of operations by service category with comparison to the two prior years.
- Certified annual financial statements and payment of gaming taxes; competition law applies to all but the concessionaire; casinos carry arts. 16–17.
- ARJH publishes decisions, runs AML, match-fixing and minor-protection workstreams, and maintains an 'Interdiction de jeux' page.

TAX STACK

Gaming tax is 7% (concessionaire) or 5% (partners) of net receipts, stacked with 30% BIC, 7.5% winnings withholding, the redevance and a 2026 virtual-PE tax.

- Art. 1149: 7% of net product, raised from 5% by Loi 2024-1109 of 18 December 2024, estimated +XOF 2bn (~$4m), partly earmarked to civic service and youth employment.
- Art. 1150: 5% on non-concessionaire operators 'quel que soit le lieu d'implantation', collected by LONACI by the 15th of the following month; foreign operators self-declare under CGI arts. 437–439; since 2025, 15% goes to the Office National des Sports.
- BIC 30% for gambling companies from 2025 (previously 25%), aligning with a UEMOA directive and matching telecoms.
- Art. 94: 7.5% withholding on winnings of XOF 1,000,000 (~$1,786) or more, excluding slots, from the 2018 budget (Loi 2017-870); 7.5% on commissions to non-salaried resellers.
- Redevance XOF 15bn (~$27m) in 2024 and XOF 21bn (~$38m) in 2025; from 5 January 2026, 'établissement stable virtuel' taxes foreign platforms at 30% of a deemed 10% margin above XOF 50m (~$89k).

WORKED ILLUSTRATION

The gaming-tax line is not the problem; undisclosed partner economics, 30% BIC and the 7.5% winnings withholding are.

- On XOF 10bn (~$18m) of net gaming receipts, Art. 1150 takes XOF 0.5bn; an assumed 10–15% agrément fee [assumption – not disclosed] takes a further XOF 1.0–1.5bn.
- Marketing, platform, payment and staff costs absorb the bulk of the remainder; 30% BIC applies to residual profit.
- The 7.5% withholding is experienced as a worse price on big wins and pushes high-ticket play toward unlicensed offshore sites.
- LONACI pays 7% while partners pay 5%, but LONACI carries the redevance, so effective gaming-tax burdens are broadly comparable.

LICENSING & TAX – RULES AS AT OCT 2026	RULE / RATE	WHO IT APPLIES TO	SINCE / CHANGE	SOURCE
LICENSING				
Concession (exclusive) – lotteries, scratch, number, horse & sports betting, virtuals, online games, online casino & slots	State convention 5 Jul 2021 + Décret 2023-945	LONACI only	In force 1 Jan 2024	Loi 2020-480 art. 8; ARJH
LONACI agrément for third-party online brands	Bilateral; terms, fee, duration not published (n/a)	17 private brands	3 in Dec 2023 → 17 in Oct 2026	LONACI communiqué; ARJH register
ARJH authorisation – casinos, slot halls, promotional & charitable lotteries	Issued/renewed/withdrawn by ARJH; 'contreparties financières' fixed by decree (amounts n/a)	Private land-based & promoters	Décret 2023-946 (6 Dec 2023); competence moved from two ministries to ARJH	Conseil des ministres 6 Dec 2023
Software homologation	Mandatory, systematic	All operators	Current	ARJH
Reporting	Analytical accounts; annual activity report (flows by product, 3-yr comparison); certified accounts	All operators	Loi 2020-480 arts. 12–15	ARJH FAQ
Competition law	Applies to all operators except the concessionaire	Non-LONACI	Loi 2020-480 art. 13	ARJH FAQ
TAXES				
Taxe sur les jeux de hasard (Art. 1149 CGI)	7% of net product of sales, commissions & brokerage	Concessionaire (LONACI)	5% → 7% from Jan 2025 (Loi 2024-1109); +XOF 2bn (~$4m) est. yield	DGBF Annexe fiscale 2025; CGI
Taxe sur les jeux de hasard en ligne (Art. 1150 CGI)	5% of net gaming receipts; collected via LONACI (local) or self-declared (offshore)	Online operators other than concessionaire, wherever established	Since 2024; 15% earmarked to ONS from 2025	Annexe fiscale 2024 art. 4; 2025 art. 22
Corporate income tax (BIC)	30%	All gambling companies	25% → 30% from 2025	Annexe fiscale 2025
Winnings withholding (Art. 94 CGI)	7.5% on wins ≥ XOF 1,000,000 (~$1,786); slot wins exempt	Players (withheld by operator)	Since 2018 (Loi 2017-870)	CGI; Trésor public
Reseller/agent commission withholding (Art. 94 CGI)	7.5% of gross commissions to non-salaried intermediaries	Operators paying agents	Current	CGI
Concession redevance	XOF 21bn (~$38m) FY2025; XOF 15bn (~$27m) FY2024	LONACI	+40%	AIP
Virtual permanent establishment tax	30% × deemed 10% margin (=3% of turnover) above XOF 50m (~$89k) remote sales	Foreign online platforms	From 5 Jan 2026 (Loi 2025-987)	DGBF Annexe fiscale 2026
Casino / slot-hall gaming tax rate	[unverified]	Land-based private	—	Texts not located

7 DEEP-DIVE — PAYMENTS, RESPONSIBLE GAMBLING & ENFORCEMENT

Mobile money is the rail, 18+/21+ and operator reporting are the player-protection core, and the State has just built a dedicated enforcement unit with police powers.

PAYMENTS

Mobile money is the deposit and withdrawal rail for every online brand; quantitative gambling-payment penetration figures are n/a.

- Registered operators include BetMobile Money SA (Betmomo) and MPayment SAS (Winabet), brands built around mobile-money wallets.
- LONACI's 2025 narrative leads with digitalisation and a 20% larger kiosk network: cash-in at retail plus wallet top-ups online.
- Orange Money, MTN MoMo, Wave and Moov Money form the backbone [general market knowledge; shares and limits not verified].
- Entrants must price wallet integration cost, agent cash-out economics and 7.5% withholding mechanics on large payouts; card and bank-transfer rails are marginal.

PLAYER PROTECTION

Player protection rests on 18+/21+ age rules and ARJH programmes rather than a detailed code; advertising restrictions look like a classic next step.

- Legal age is 18 for all games and 21 for casinos and slot halls (art. 59); casinos and slot halls confined to 4-star hotels.
- ARJH website covers 'Je maîtrise mon jeu', addiction prevention, match-fixing, illegal supply, minors, AML/CFT and a game prohibition page.
- No specific rules on advertising content, bonus caps, deposit limits or affordability were found [unverified].
- Sponsorship is extensive (Betclic–ASEC Mimosas; 1xBet–FIF and CAN 2023; LONACI–CAN Maroc 2025) and fiscal exposés repeatedly cite youth exposure as a policy concern.

ENFORCEMENT CAPACITY

Enforcement has stepped up in three moves, culminating in Décret 2026-236 creating the USSJH with police-backed powers.

- 2023 decrees gave the ARJH sole authorisation competence and declared any non-LONACI operation of concessioned games illegal nationwide.
- 2024 budget let the tax authority suspend non-filing foreign platforms; 2026 budget added the virtual-PE tax with reinforced sanctions.
- Décret 2026-236 of 29 April 2026 created the USSJH, staffed by sworn agents, public security forces and ARJH representatives, with broad investigation and repression powers.
- Stated rationale is proliferation of unauthorised slot and loto operators, with AML secondary; the August 2025 destruction of 110 machines was the visible precursor.

> *"aussi bien en ligne que sur le réseau physique"* — **LONACI DG**

AML AND OUTLOOK

The regulator now has sole authorisation power, a field unit and blocking powers – net positive for licensed operators, but audits become routine compliance cost.

- AML obligations flow from the law and the ARJH's AML page; the 7.5% withholding on wins ≥ XOF 1m creates a de facto large-payout reporting trail.
- No ARJH fine or licence-withdrawal statistics located (n/a); the 'Décisions' page could not be read in this pass.
- The grey market is the main competitor for share, so enforcement is net positive for licensed operators.
- Agrément-holders should expect audits of flows by product and three-year comparisons.

PAYMENTS, RG & ENFORCEMENT – FACTS VERIFIED	VALUE	PERIOD	CHANGE	BASIS & SOURCE
PAYMENTS				
Mobile-money share of gambling deposits; wallet limits	n/a	—	—	Not published; mobile money dominant [qualitative]
Mobile-money-branded licensed operators	Betmomo (BetMobile Money SA); Winabet (MPayment SAS)	Oct 2026	—	ARJH register
Withholding on large payouts	7.5% on wins ≥ XOF 1,000,000 (~$1,786)	Since 2018	—	CGI art. 94
RESPONSIBLE GAMBLING				
Minimum age – general / casinos & slot halls	18 / 21	Current	—	Loi 2020-480 art. 59
Casino & slot-hall location	4-star hotels only	Current	—	MinFin statement on the law
ARJH programmes	Addiction prevention; minors; match-fixing; AML; illegal-offer; game prohibition (self-exclusion)	Current	—	arjh.ci
Advertising / bonus / deposit-limit rules	[unverified] – not located in texts read	—	—	—
ENFORCEMENT				
Illegal slot machines destroyed	110 + components	28 Aug 2025	—	KOACI / allAfrica / Abidjan.net
USSJH created (Décret 2026-236)	Sworn agents + security forces + ARJH; nationwide investigation & repression powers	29 Apr 2026	New	AIP; Conseil des ministres
Platform suspension for non-filing offshore operators	Available to tax authority	Since 2024	—	Annexe fiscale 2024 (CGI arts. 437–439)
ARJH fines / withdrawals	n/a	—	—	Decisions page not read

8 HIGHLIGHTS & LOWLIGHTS

▲ HIGHLIGHTS

- Scale with momentum: licensed-sector turnover XOF 705.9bn (~$1.26bn) in 2024, +20.5% after +28.8% in 2023; LONACI still compounding 13–14% with a XOF 744.3bn (~$1.33bn) 2026 target – one of francophone Africa's largest regulated pools. structural
- Low headline gaming tax: 5% of net receipts for private online partners (Art. 1150) versus 15–20% GGR regimes in Kenya/Ghana, with no turnover tax – margin-friendly if partner economics are sane. structural
- A sanctioned private route exists and is widening: 3 agréments in Dec 2023 → 17 in Oct 2026, spanning European, CIS and pan-African brands – LONACI has shown willingness to sign new partners. structural
- Concentration leaves room for a #2: Betclic holds 55.2% of September demand but 1xBet is only 11.8% and the next 13+ brands share roughly a third – a well-capitalised, mobile-money-native challenger can plausibly build a double-digit share. mixed
- Enforcement is turning pro-licensed: the USSJH (Apr 2026), platform-blocking powers (2024) and the virtual-PE tax (2026) all raise the cost of grey-market competition and should channel demand to agrément-holders. structural
- Event tailwinds: September's +21.7% MoM demand spike around the CIV–Ghana AFCON qualifier shows football-driven elasticity; LONACI's own relaunch of sports/horse betting signals the concessionaire wants the vertical to grow. one-off
- Retail cash-in network is deep and growing (LONACI POS +20% in 2025) – a partner able to piggyback on kiosk distribution for deposits can lower CAC versus pure digital acquisition. structural

▼ LOWLIGHTS

- Concession dependency: there is no stand-alone online licence; market access is a bilateral LONACI agrément with undisclosed fee, scope and duration, revocable by a counterparty that is also a competitor and is exempt from competition law. structural
- Concessionaire margin squeeze: LONACI EBITDA -37% to XOF 21.0bn (~$38m) and net profit >-43% in 2025 while its State redevance rose 40% – the obvious remedies (higher partner fees, fewer partners, favouring its own online brand) all hit third parties. watch
- Tax ratchet: three consecutive budgets raised or added gambling taxes (online tax 2024; 5%→7% and BIC 25%→30% in 2025; virtual-PE tax 2026); the 2027 Annexe fiscale (Dec 2026) is a live risk for a further increase or a lower winnings-withholding threshold. structural
- Player-price friction: 7.5% withholding on wins ≥ XOF 1m (~$1,786) degrades high-ticket sports multiples and incentivises offshore leakage exactly where regulated operators earn most. structural
- Data opacity: no sector GGR, no online/retail split, no product GGR, no licence-fee schedule – business cases must be built on turnover proxies, Blask search shares and derived estimates (LONACI implied GGR ~XOF 244bn / ~$435m). structural
- Online casino legal ambiguity: casino and slots online are concessioned; private casino content is lawful only to the extent an agrément covers it, and the slot-winnings WHT exemption was drafted for physical machines – scope and tax treatment are untested. governance
- Governance/political: the concessionaire is majority State-owned, the regulator sits under the Finance Ministry and the new USSJH blends police and regulator – policy can move fast by decree (the 2023 decrees reset the market in weeks) with limited consultation. governance

9 FORECAST & OUTLOOK

Guidance bridge. There is no formal guidance for a market, so the bridge is from the last regulator datapoint to the concessionaire's stated target and our own estimate. The ARJH's FY2024 licensed-sector turnover of XOF 705.9bn (~$1.26bn) is the anchor; LONACI delivered XOF 657.6bn (~$1.17bn) in FY2025 (+13.5%) and targets XOF 744.3bn (~$1.33bn) for FY2026 (+13.2%), driven by digitalisation, the relaunch of sports and horse betting, new scratch games and loyalty programmes. The swing factor is the private agrément cohort, which was a derived ~XOF 127bn (~$226m) of 2024 turnover across 3–5 active brands and now numbers 17 brands with demand indices up double digits – we estimate private turnover of ~XOF 180–220bn (~$320–390m) in 2026 [estimate], taking the licensed sector to roughly XOF 0.92–0.96tn (~$1.65–1.72bn) [estimate]. Fiscal moving parts: the 7% Art. 1149 tax and 30% BIC are now fully in the base; the 2026 virtual-PE tax adds offshore-side pressure; the 2027 budget is the next event.

LICENSED-SECTOR TURNOVER FY2024 (ARJH, ACTUAL)	LONACI TURNOVER FY2025 (ACTUAL) → FY2026 TARGET	PRIVATE AGRÉMENT COHORT TURNOVER FY2026 [ESTIMATE]	LICENSED-SECTOR TURNOVER FY2026 [ESTIMATE]
XOF 705.9bn (~$1.26bn)	**XOF 657.6bn → XOF 744.3bn (~$1.17bn → ~$1.33bn)**	**~XOF 180–220bn (~$320–390m)**	**~XOF 0.92–0.96tn (~$1.65–1.72bn)**
+20.5% YoY	+13.5% → +13.2%	vs ~XOF 127bn (~$226m) derived for FY2024; 17 brands vs 3–5	≈ +14–17% CAGR 2024–26E

Independent view. Our independent view: the market keeps compounding at **low-to-mid teens in turnover** through 2027, but **GGR grows slower than stakes** as LONACI's payout drifts above 63% and partner brands compete on price and bonuses; sector GGR is unobservable, so we would underwrite on LONACI's implied ~XOF 244bn (~$435m) 2025 GGR growing ~8–10% plus a faster-growing private pool. **Regulatory direction is toward tighter control, not liberalisation**: expect (i) the USSJH to produce visible raids, seizures and a first public blocking list within 12 months; (ii) the Dec 2026 Annexe fiscale to touch gambling again – most likely the Art. 1150 online rate (5%→7% to match Art. 1149 is the obvious 'equity' move) or a lower winnings-withholding threshold; (iii) LONACI to formalise and monetise its partner programme under the 2026–2030 strategic plan, with a published agrément tariff and possibly a cap on brand numbers as it defends its own 6%-share online brand; and (iv) advertising/sponsorship rules to appear in some form given the repeated 'youth' framing in fiscal exposés. **Leverage/structure direction**: LONACI's capital increase to XOF 5bn (~$9m) and compressed margins point to a concessionaire that will seek more from partners – entrants should price an agrément fee step-up into year-2/3 economics. Probability-weighted, Côte d'Ivoire remains an attractive but **partner-dependent** market: the binding constraints are contractual (LONACI) and fiscal (BIC 30%, WHT 7.5%) rather than licensing or demand.

What to watch next quarter:

- ARJH Rapport d'activités 2025 (expected H2 2026/H1 2027): first chance of a published sector GGR, online/retail split and product mix; also any disclosure of agrément/authorisation fee schedules.
- Annexe fiscale 2027 (Council of Ministers/Parliament, Nov–Dec 2026; in force early Jan 2027): any change to Art. 1149/1150 rates, the XOF 1m winnings-withholding threshold, ONS earmarking, or extension of the virtual-PE tax enforcement to gambling platforms.
- USSJH operationalisation under Décret 2026-236: first raids, seizures, site-blocking orders and any published list of unauthorised sites; coordination with DGI platform-suspension powers.
- LONACI partner policy under the 2026–2030 strategic plan: new agréments or withdrawals (PremierBet's disappearance from the register is a precedent), fee changes, and performance of Lonaci Online/MAJX/Sportcash versus Betclic.
- LONACI 2026 results (Feb 2027): delivery against the XOF 744.3bn (~$1.33bn) target, payout ratio, EBITDA recovery and redevance level – the health of the counterparty every private brand depends on.
- Online casino scope: any ARJH decision, homologation list or LONACI statement clarifying whether partner agréments cover casino/crash/virtuals and how the slot-winnings WHT exemption applies online.
- Advertising and sponsorship: emergence of any ARJH guideline or decree on gambling advertising, bonuses or minors, and how sponsorship of Ivorian clubs/FIF is treated.
- Monthly Blask/market-demand reads through the 2026-27 football calendar (AFCON qualifiers, European leagues) to track whether Betclic's >55% share holds as new entrants scale.

DATA CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM Primary figures verified against regulator/state sources: ARJH register and market page (operator counts; sector turnover XOF 705.9bn 2024, 585.9bn 2023), ARJH founding texts (Loi 2020-480; Décrets 2021-301, 2023-945, 2023-946, 2026-236), Conseil des ministres communiqué (6 Dec 2023), DGBF Annexes fiscales 2025 and 2026, consolidated CGI arts. 94/1149/1150, Trésor public (7.5% WHT), AIP (LONACI FY2025 results, USSJH). ARJH annual-report PDFs (2022–2024) were listed but could not be opened in this pass, so NO sector GGR, online/retail split, product GGR, tax take or licence-fee amounts are available – marked n/a. LONACI GGR (~XOF 243.7bn 2025), non-LONACI turnover (~XOF 126.6bn 2024), LONACI share (~82%) and all 2026 sector figures are analyst derivations/estimates. Blask shares are search-demand proxies (secondary), not GGR. Casino gaming-tax rate, advertising rules, agrément scope for casino and local-ownership requirements are [unverified]. FX: XOF is pegged at 655.957/EUR; the USD/XOF rate for 30 Sep 2026 could not be retrieved before tool limits were reached, so USD conversions use an ASSUMED 560 XOF/USD (≈EUR/USD 1.17) – replace with the 30 Sep 2026 fix before circulation; a ±5% FX move shifts all ~USD figures proportionally.

Sources: [Primary] ARJH – Opérateurs (register of concessionaire, online/sports-betting, casino and slot-hall operators; FAQ on concession and obligations); [Primary] ARJH – Marché des jeux (sector turnover XOF 585.9bn 2023 → 705.9bn 2024; licensed lists); [Primary] ARJH – Offres de jeux (concession vs authorisation game lists); [Primary] ARJH – Textes fondateurs (Loi 2020-480; Décrets 2021-301, 2023-945, 2023-946, 2026-236); [Primary] ARJH – Rapports d'activités 2022/2023/2024 (listed; PDFs not readable in this pass); [Primary] Loi n° 2020-480 du 27 mai 2020 portant régime juridique des jeux de hasard (Assemblée nationale PDF); [Primary] Communiqué du Conseil des Ministres, 6 Dec 2023 (Décrets 2023-945 and 2023-946); [Primary] Ministère des Finances – adoption of the gambling law (age 18/21; 4-star hotel rule); [Primary] DGBF – Annexe fiscale 2025 (note de présentation: 5%→7% gaming tax; BIC 25%→30%; 15% of online tax to ONS); [Primary] DGBF – Annexe fiscale 2026 / Loi de finances 2025-987 (virtual permanent establishment tax); [Primary] Annexe fiscale 2024 text – Art. 1150 CGI online gambling tax (OEC mirror); [Primary] Code général des impôts (consolidated) – arts. 94, 1149, 1150; [Primary] Direction Générale du Trésor – 7.5% withholding on winnings ≥ XOF 1m (Annexe fiscale 2018); [Primary] AIP (state news agency) – LONACI FY2025 results, redevance, 2026 target (2 Feb 2026); [Primary] AIP – Government creates the USSJH (29 Apr 2026); [Primary] LONACI – DG statement on the concession decree and agréments to 1xBet, Betclic, PremierBet; [Secondary] iGaming Afrika / Blask – 'Ivory Coast reserved online sports to Lonaci as Betclic held 55.2% of demand' (21 Oct 2026); [Secondary] Connectionivoirienne / AfriBallon barometer – francophone sports-betting regulation study (21 Oct 2026); [Secondary] Afriveille – LONACI 2025 accounts: value added, EBITDA, net profit; [Secondary] Abidjan.net – ARJH incineration of illegal slot machines; regulator sector data 2022–2023 (Aug 2025); [Secondary] KOACI – Annexe fiscale 2024 online gambling tax mechanics; [Secondary] Digital Mag – Annexe fiscale 2025: 30% BIC and 7% gaming tax; [Secondary] Digital Mag – Annexe fiscale 2026 virtual-PE tax explained; [Secondary] Ouestaf – USSJH decree coverage; [Secondary] 7info – LONACI communiqué of 8 Dec 2023 listing agréments; [Secondary] Abidjan.net – LONACI 2024 turnover target XOF 545bn; [Secondary] gamebridge.io – Côte d'Ivoire online gambling guide (corroboration of regime).

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